INNOVATION CATALYST

Software Development Engineer Intern | 2027-2028

What You'll Do as an Innovation Catalyst

Innovation Catalysts are Trilogy Innovation's builders.

Your job is not to write code. Your job is to solve customer problems.

From your first few weeks, you'll own a real product or a meaningful part of one. You'll work directly with customers to understand their business, identify the real problem worth solving, and design a solution that creates measurable value. There is no product manager deciding what to build for you. You are expected to develop that understanding yourself.

Once you understand the problem, you decide how to solve it. We don't hire for a particular technology stack because the stack isn't the job. Strong computer science fundamentals allow you to learn whatever technology the problem demands.

You'll use AI throughout your work to research unfamiliar domains, explore designs, generate code, create tests, and automate repetitive work. But AI is a tool, not the decision-maker. Your responsibility is to frame the problem, direct the AI, recognise when it's wrong, and apply your own judgement to build the right solution.

The pace is intentionally high. We expect one Innovation Catalyst to deliver in days what might take much larger teams weeks elsewhere, not by working longer hours, but by thinking better, prioritising relentlessly, and using AI effectively without compromising quality.

Ownership extends beyond building features. You're expected to communicate directly with customers, raise risks before anyone asks, seek help when you're stuck, automate repetitive work, and continuously look for better ways to solve the customer's problem, not just the one they originally asked for.

Think of yourself as the CEO of your product. You own the outcome, not just the implementation.

If this description feels demanding, that is intentional. If that sounds exciting rather than intimidating, keep reading.

The section that follows explains more about how we work, what we value, and how to decide honestly whether this is your kind of job.

Read This Before You Apply

A transparent guide to how we work, what we value, and whether you'll thrive here.

Where we stand on AI

AI is the most powerful tool ever put in a builder's hands, and the people who are most valuable to us are the ones who can drive it the hardest. Most companies still treat AI use like a guilty secret. We treat it as the core skill.

What we mean by "driving" AI

Driving AI is not typing "build me X" and accepting whatever comes back. It is a leadership job, and we expect it at every level, including entry level:

- Delegate like an executive, not a developer. Break a problem into pieces an agent can execute well, give each piece the context it needs, and sequence the work.
- Detect bluffing. AI states wrong things with total confidence. You need enough foundational computer science to smell it and know when the design is subtly broken, the test proves nothing, or the explanation is hollow.
- Bring what the AI can't. Situational awareness (the real constraints, the real users, what actually matters right now) lives in your head. Your job is to articulate it so clearly that the agent makes better decisions.
- Ask for advice, not just code. The strongest people we've seen use AI as a sounding board for design and tradeoffs, then make the call themselves.
- Be the expert. The AI isn't. An AI's opinion is the average of every opinion it was trained on. Average is exactly what we don't hire for. The deep insight that changes a product comes from expertise you build in the domain, and the AI amplifies it. If you outsource the expertise itself, there is nothing to amplify.
- This is why CS fundamentals are non-negotiable here. Without them you cannot learn new stacks at the speed we need, and you cannot tell when the AI is confidently messing things up. AI doesn't lower the bar on fundamentals. It raises the return on them.

Who thrives here

- Product builders, not task doers. You have found a problem and built a solution because it bothered you, ideally outside of coursework or a job assignment. Nobody asked you to. That instinct is what we hire for.
- One-person companies. You own outcomes, not tasks. When you're blocked, you don't wait to be rescued. You ask the right questions, pull in the help and resources you need, and keep driving until the problem is solved. You own the project from start to finish.
- Comfortable in front of customers. You don't hide behind a product manager or a lead. You want to understand customer problems firsthand, ask better questions than they expected, and steer them toward the solution that creates the most value. Over time, customers trust you, not just as someone who builds what they ask for, but as someone who tells them what's worth Building.
- Fluent in the "why." You can explain the business value of what you're building: what it does for users, what it's worth to the customer, and what it does better than the alternatives. If you can't answer those questions, you don't consider the work understood, let alone done.
- Sponges. New tech, new ideas, new domains don't overwhelm you. You absorb them fast, can explain them clearly to someone else, and apply them to a real problem within days, not months.
- Opinionated and open. You hold clear positions, can defend them with reasons, and argue for them with energy, and when someone shows you a better argument, you actually change your mind.
- Curious and positive. You default to "how does this work?" and "how do we make this work?" rather than "that's not my job" and "that won't work."

Who should not apply

We'd rather you self-select out now than be unhappy later. This is probably not your job if:

- You want detailed tickets handed to you and clear instructions for every task. Here, finding and framing the problem is part of the job.
- You want someone else to talk to the customers and tell you what to build. Here, the customer conversation is part of your job, not a layer above you.
- You can describe what you built but not why anyone would pay for it. Code without a value story is half the job.
- You see AI as a threat to hide from, or a shortcut to disguise. We will ask to see exactly how you work with it.

- You skipped the fundamentals and hoped the tools would cover for you. They won't and you'll feel it here quickly.
- You'd rather let the AI have opinions. We hire experts who use AI, not operators who relay it.
- You need someone else to set the pace. Nobody here will chase you.
- You'd rather keep the peace than voice a disagreement. We need your real opinion, especially when it's inconvenient.

What happens next

If this sounds like you, the next step is ADD: a 30-minute live coding assessment in a live environment, where you work with an AI agent as you would on a real task.

A few practical details

Role: Software Development Engineer (SDE) Intern

Work mode: Fully remote, 40 hours/week

2027 graduates: Winter Internship | 6 months | January-June 2027

2028 graduates: Summer Internship | 2 months | Starting mid-May 2027

Eligibility: No prior internship or full-time work experience is required. We weigh self-driven projects (see "Who thrives here") more heavily than resume lines.

Stipend & growth: ₹75,000/month during the internship. Strong performers convert to a full-time offer at the end of it. From there, growth looks like SDE-1 (₹30L CTC) → SDE-2 (₹48L CTC) → SDE-3 (₹65L CTC), each a real step up in scope and compensation, with an annual performance bonus at every level.

Process: Fully online.

1. ADD · 30 minutes: A live coding assessment in a live environment, where you work with an AI agent as you would on a real task.
2. CCAT · 15 minutes: A 50-question cognitive aptitude test. A score of 40/50 is required to move forward.
3. TR1 · Technical Round 1: 30 minutes.
4. TR2 · Technical Round 2: 1 hour.
5. Culture Fit Round: 20 minutes, if required.
6. PCCAT · 15 minutes: Proctored version of CCAT; 50 questions, with a 40/50 cutoff.

PCCAT is not mandatory for the internship. It is required only for full-time conversion.